José Caballero

COST OF FAR-OFF CHASES

11.7

runs per 600 PA from your choices on pitches 4+ inches off the plate

Bats right · 2026 · 453 PA · xChase+ 79, 246th of 261

Swings at 36% of pitches outside the zone. Hitters on average swing at 31% of the same pitches.

What to work on

1. With two strikes, let fastballs above the zone go. You swung at 81% of them; hitters on average swing at 51%. The ones you swung at were typically 6 inches off the zone. leak 1
2. With two strikes, let breaking balls below the zone go. You swung at 77% of them; hitters on average swing at 51%. The ones you swung at were typically 5 inches off the zone. leak 2

- Your choices also cost about 1 run a season when you're ahead in the count, where leak 3 is one for video with your coaches.

Keep swinging at strikes. The changes to start with are the pitches above.

TARGET

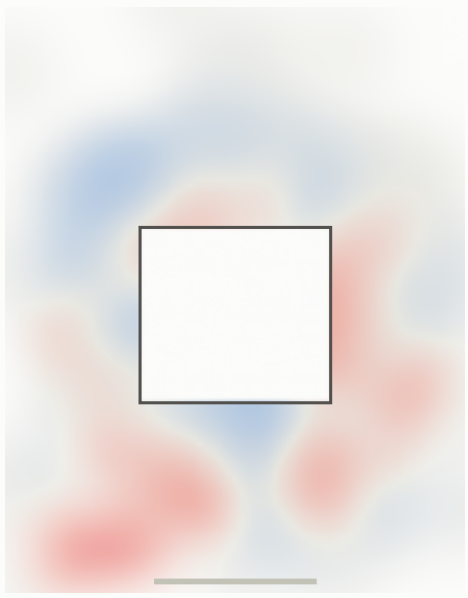
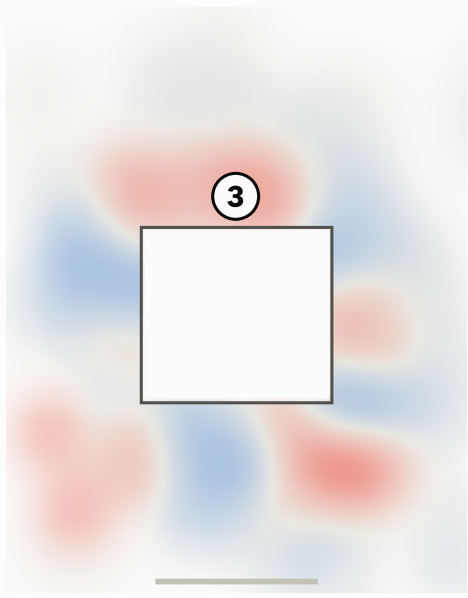
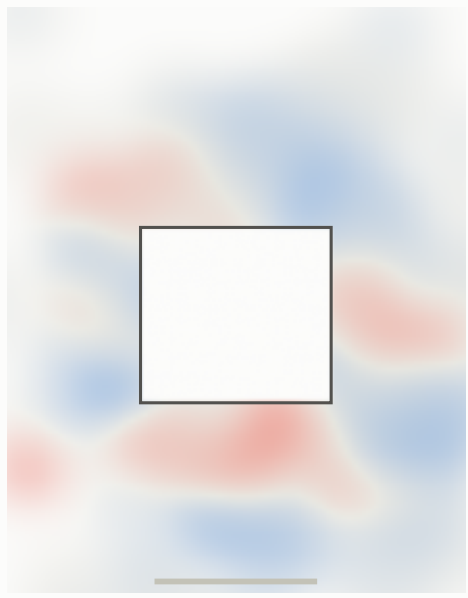
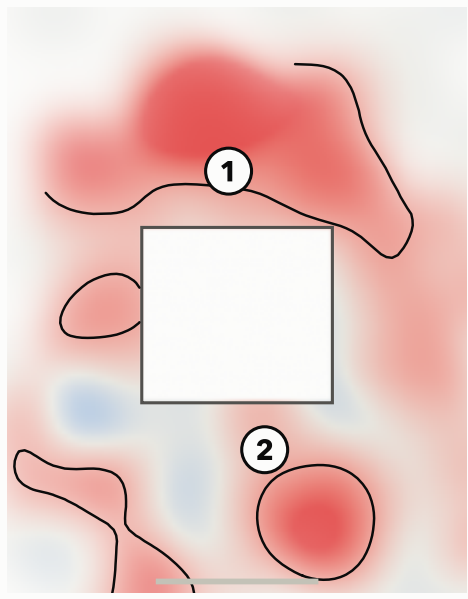
Leaks 1 to 3 together: you chased 24 points above the league's chase rate in 2026 (28 on the rows above; the target uses a simpler league rate, the one it is scored on). Those spots get better on their own, so with no change you'd be about 14 points above it in 2027. Under 14 is a fix.

COACH'S NOTE, FOR THE STAFF

With two strikes, fastballs above the zone: the plan's first line, then breaking balls below the zone. He has chased more of the far-off (4+ inch) fastballs above the zone with two strikes every year (55%, 65%, 77% since 2024; 81% in 2026 counting the near ones, as the leak list does), even in 2025, when his xChase+ was 109.

Where you chase

−30 pts league +30 pts

	First pitch (0-0)	Ahead in the count (1-0 2-0 3-0 2-1 3-1)	0-1 or 1-1 (even or behind)	Two strikes (0-2 1-2 2-2 3-2)
All pitchers				

Inside Away catcher's view, to scale

Red: you chase more than the average hitter at that spot and count. Blue: you take more. Gray: about average. White: too few pitches to say. Outline: 15 points or more over.

Biggest leaks

numbered on the pictures · runs per 600 PA

1	Two strikes, fastballs above the zone	81% vs 51% · 57 of 70	**−5.6**
2	Two strikes, breaking balls below the zone	77% vs 51% · 24 of 31	**−2.4**
3	Ahead in the count, fastballs above the zone	52% vs 30% · 12 of 23	**−1.4**

You vs the average hitter on the same pitches; the runs are what the swing choices cost. Ranked by runs; the plan takes up to two, in the order to work on them.

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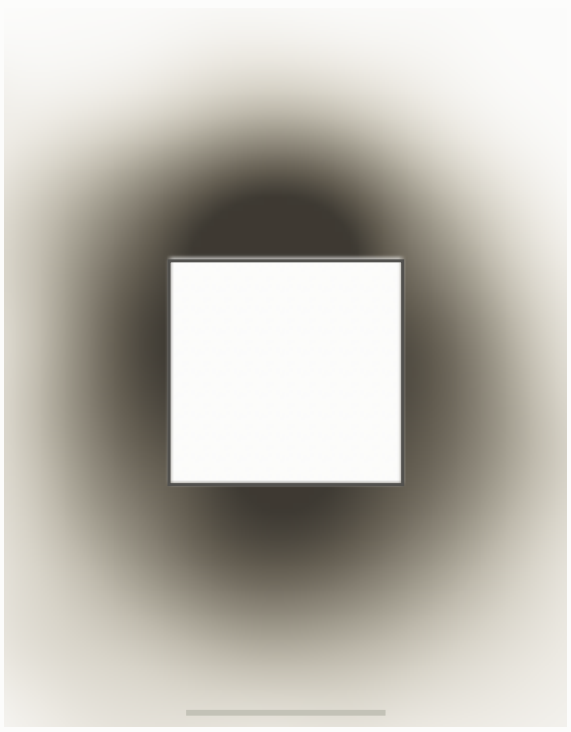
runs per 600 PA from your choices on pitches 4+ inches off the plate

How to read your card

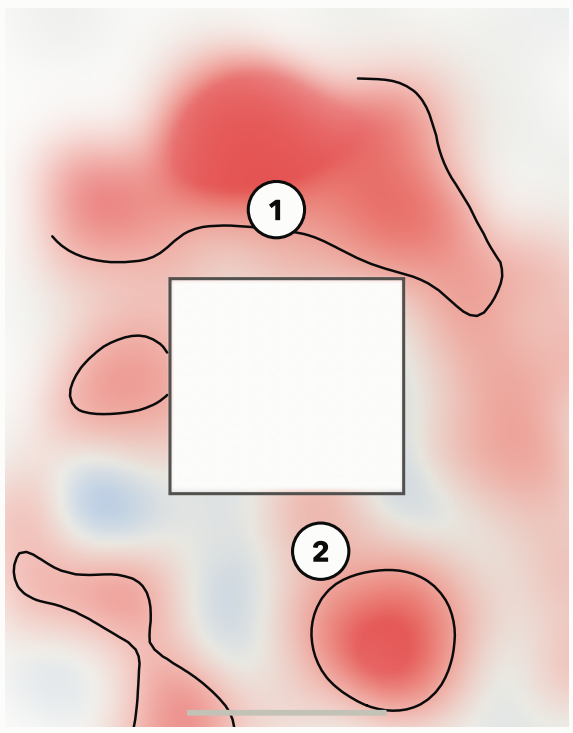
1. Red is where you swing at balls more than other hitters do at the same spot and in the same count. Blue is where you take more than they do. Gray is about average. White means you haven't seen enough pitches there to say.
2. The box is your strike zone, seen from the catcher. The line under it is home plate. Everyone chases more with two strikes, so the comparison is always with hitters in the same count. Nobody is judged for a two-strike swing everyone makes.
3. The numbers on the pictures are your biggest leaks, ranked by what your swing choices cost over a full season, each on the row of pictures its pitches are in (a leak against right-handers is on the vs RHP row). Each plan line is tagged with its leak's number.
4. The plan is one pitch per line, numbered 1 and 2 in the order to work on them: a take before two strikes comes first, because it costs nothing in strikeouts, when you have seen enough of those pitches to trust the number, unless your coaches picked where to start. A line under them names a bigger leak or a costly count that comes later. A take rule is for the pitch that is clearly a ball; each line says how far off the plate the ones you swung at were, and a pitch that was mostly borderline is one to go over on video with your coaches, not a take. Keep swinging at strikes.
5. The target covers every leak on the card, together, in points above the league's chase rate. Everyone's worst spots look better the next season by themselves, and that is the numbers settling, not you improving. The second number is where you would land doing nothing. Under it is a fix. Matching it is not.
6. The cost of far-off chases is what your choices on pitches at least 4 inches off the plate cost over 600 plate appearances, compared with an average hitter. Hitters who cut their leak chasing mostly stopped losing runs; the walks come first, the hits come later if they come.

What normal looks like, with two strikes

The average hitter: how often they swing



You: more (red) or less (blue) than that



Average hitter's chase rate

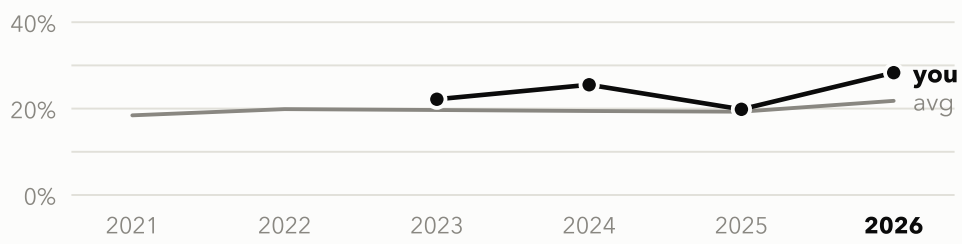
0% 70%+

You vs the average hitter

−30 pts league +30 pts

The average hitter chases most with two strikes, below and away. Your card only shows where you differ from that.

Far-off chase rate by season



Pitches at least 4 inches off the plate: you against every hitter.

Does fixing a leak pay? Hitters who cut their leak chasing more than expected stopped giving counts away: more walks, no more strikeouts, still swinging at strikes. The gain was mostly runs not lost; hits come later, if they come.